Team Launch

Get a new team or initiative ready to deliver in one or two weeks, and deliver something real while you do it.

Set Up the Team · Often Called Sprint Zero or Iteration 0 · Timeboxed · Thin First Slice

TEAM _____

LAUNCH DATES _____

1 Launch Goal

THE LAUNCH IS DONE WHEN…

We'll start delivering by _____ *and by then we will have:*

2 Timebox

SHORT ON PURPOSE

☐ 1 week ☐ 2 weeks ☐ Other: _____

Launch owner: _____ Daily check-in at: _____

3 Launch Checklist

TICK WHEN DONE · EACH ITEM LINKS TO A TOOL · DO JUST ENOUGH

Why & What

- ☐ Purpose and problem agreed
  → Project Kickoff
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Product vision written
  → Product Vision Board
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Users understood
  → Persona & Journey Map
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Outcomes and measures
  → Impact Map · OKRs
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Stakeholders mapped
  → Stakeholder Map
  Owner: _____

The Team

- ☐ Charter and working agreements
  → Team Charter
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Roles and accountability clear
  → RACI & Decision Log
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Skills and gaps known
  → Skills Matrix
  Owner: _____
- ☐ AI use agreed
  → AI Working Agreement
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Decision rights agreed
  → Delegation Board
  Owner: _____

The Backlog

- ☐ Journey and first release slice
  → User Story Map
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Epic shaped, with an MVP
  → Epic Breakdown Canvas
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Items right-sized
  → Story Splitting · Backlog Item Anatomy
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Top items understood
  → Example Mapping
  Owner: _____
- ☐ First forecast range
  → Release Forecast
  Owner: _____

Ways of Working

- ☐ Board, workflow and WIP limits
  → Kanban Board Design
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Definition of Done agreed
  → Team Charter
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Cadence and events booked
  → Sprint Planning · Review · Retro
  Owner: _____
- ☐ Risks named and owned
  → Pre-mortem · RAID Log
  Owner: _____
- ☐ First retro booked
  → Retrospective Kit
  Owner: _____

4 Thin First Slice

DELIVER SOMETHING REAL

However small, finish something a user could see or use.

Slice: _____

Who it's for: _____

Done when: _____

☐ It runs end to end, from input to output (a walking skeleton)

5 Environment & Tools

EVERYONE CAN WORK ON DAY ONE

- ☐ Code repository and access for everyone
- ☐ Build and deploy pipeline to a test environment
- ☐ Team board set up in the team's tool
- ☐ Shared channel, calendar and document space
- ☐ Development setup works on every machine
- ☐ Test data and environments available

6 Ready to Start?

THE EXIT CHECK

- ☐ Vision and first outcome agreed
- ☐ Top of the backlog ready for 1–2 iterations
- ☐ Definition of Done agreed
- ☐ First slice planned or already done
- ☐ Everyone can contribute from day one

Watch for: running past the timebox · designing everything up front · delivering nothing

"What's the least we need to agree before we can start delivering?"

"What could we deliver this week, however small?"

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